

PAPER 2: CONFLICT IN THE MIDDLE EAST, 1945-1995

KT₂

Assessment Question: Why has peace proved so elusive in the Middle East?

Name: _____

Class: _____

Progress & Assessment Tracker	Effort	Level	Teacher Comments
L1: KT2.1: The Six Day War, 1967			
L2: KT2.2: The Aftermath of the 1967 War			
L3: KT2.3: Israel and Egypt, 1967–1973			
Final Unit Grade:			

L1: KT2.1: The Six Day War, 1967

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the significance of the Cairo Conference (1964) and the growth of Fatah and the PLO.
- ☐ Analyze the escalating tension between Israel, Syria and Jordan: Syria's support for Fatah, Israel's raid on Samu and the events of 7 April 1967.
- ☐ Evaluate the actions of the USSR, Nasser and the USA in the period leading to war, and the key events of the war.

In June 1967, tensions reached a boiling point. Arab armies massed on Israel's borders, and fiery rhetoric promised Israel's destruction. But in a stunning, pre-emptive strike, Israel destroyed the entire Egyptian air force on the ground. In just six days, the geopolitical landscape of the region was completely transformed.

Did you know?

- **Pre-emptive Strike:** Israel launched Operation Focus, destroying over 300 Egyptian aircraft in a few hours.
- **Golan Heights:** Israel captured this strategic high ground from Syria, heavily fortifying its northern border.
- **Sinai Peninsula:** Israel conquered the vast Sinai desert, creating a huge buffer zone between themselves and Egypt.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 5

1. Who became the President of Egypt in 1954 and positioned himself as the leading champion of Pan-Arabism?

2. What was the name of the highly secret agreement signed in October 1956 where Britain, France, and Israel planned the tripartite invasion of Egypt?

3. Explain the immediate cause behind Nasser's decision to nationalise the Suez Canal Company on 26 July 1956.

4. What was the 1955 Gaza Raid, and why was it a turning point for Egyptian defense policy?

5. How did Nasser successfully bypass Western weapons restrictions in September 1955 to rearm Egypt?

Vocabulary Check

Fill in the blanks using the vocabulary words below.

PLO (Palestine Liberation Organisation) | Fatah | Pre-emptive Strike | Casus Belli

In the 1960s, Palestinian nationalism grew stronger with the creation of the _____, an umbrella organization, and its dominant guerrilla faction, _____. Border tensions flared violently when Israel launched the _____ into the West Bank in 1966. These escalating events eventually culminated in June 1967 when Israel launched _____, a devastating pre-emptive air strike that wiped out the Arab air forces on the ground.

Q1. What was the primary objective of the Palestine Liberation Organisation (PLO) when it was established at the 1964 Cairo Conference?

Q2. How did the dispute over the River Jordan escalate tensions between Israel and the Arab states in the mid-1960s?

Q3. How did the new Syrian government support the Fatah guerrilla movement from 1966 onwards?

Q4. What was the outcome of the April 1967 air clash over Damascus, and how did it affect the Syrian leadership?

Q5. How did the Soviet Union's misinformation in May 1967 act as a catalyst for the crisis?

Q6. Identify two dangerous gambles President Nasser took between 15 May and 23 May 1967.

Q7. Describe the success of Operation Focus launched by the Israeli air force on 5 June 1967.

Q8. What were the key territorial conquests of the Israeli Defence Forces during the land war?

Q9. Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the May 1967 crisis that led to the outbreak of the Six Day War. (8 marks)

Pair & Share Activity

Prompt: Was Israel justified in launching a pre-emptive strike against Egypt? Discuss both perspectives.

Your Notes:

1. Explain the importance of the Cairo Conference (1964) for the Arab states in the years 1964-73. (8 marks)

2. Explain one consequence of Syria's support for Fatah 1964-67. (4 marks)

3. Explain one consequence of the Israeli raid on Samu, 1966, for developments in the Middle East. (4 marks)

5. Explain one consequence of disputes over the River Jordan waters. (4 marks)

4. Write a narrative account analysing the rising tension in the Middle East in the years 1964-67 which led to the Six Day War. (8 marks)

6. Explain the importance of disputes over the River Jordan waters for border tension between Israel and Syria. (8 marks)

7. Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the Six Day War 1967. (8 marks)

General Notes

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☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

L2: KT2.2: The Aftermath of the 1967 War

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand UN Resolution 242 and the continued dispute over the Suez Canal.
- ☐ Analyze the situation of Palestinian refugees and the significance of the occupied territories: Golan Heights, Gaza Strip, West Bank, Sinai and East Jerusalem.
- ☐ Evaluate the use of terrorism, Israel's response and international attitudes towards the Palestine issue: the PFLP airplane hijacks of 1970; Black September and the Munich Olympics; and the expulsion of the PLO from Jordan (1970).

The Six Day War left Israel holding territories completely inhabited by Palestinians: the West Bank, Gaza Strip, and East Jerusalem. While Israelis celebrated the reunification of Jerusalem, the UN passed Resolution 242 demanding they withdraw. The ongoing occupation of these lands remains the core of the conflict today.

Did you know?

- Resolution 242: The famous UN resolution stating 'land for peace', demanding Israeli withdrawal from occupied territories.
- The PLO: Following the Arab defeat, the Palestinian Liberation Organisation emerged as an independent military force.
- East Jerusalem: Israel unilaterally annexed the eastern half of the holy city, a move not recognised internationally.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

1. What major political organization was established at the Cairo Conference in January 1964 with the backing of the Arab League, and what was its primary objective?

2.



Who is this leader, and what organisation did he take over in 1969?

3. Explain how disputes over water resources between Israel and Syria in the mid-1960s contributed to rising regional tensions.

4. What was the Samu Raid of November 1966, and how did it affect King Hussein of Jordan's position?

5. What major air battle occurred on 7 April 1967, and how did it affect Syrian military morale?

6. How did the Soviet Union act as a catalyst for the May 1967 crisis?

7. Detail three specific actions taken by Gamal Abdel Nasser in May 1967 that Israel considered a direct casus belli (act of war).

8. What was Operation Focus, launched on 5 June 1967, and why was it so critical to the outcome of the war?

9. List the territories captured by Israel during the Six Day War and identify the nation from which each was taken.

10. Write an analytical sentence linking the May 1967 Crisis to the ultimate outcome of the Six Day War.

Vocabulary Check

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

UN Resolution 242 Khartoum Resolution PFLP Black September Operation Wrath of God

Your Sentence:

Q1. How did Israel and the Arab states interpret the ambiguous wording of UN Resolution 242 differently?

Q2. What was the defiant response of the Arab states at the August 1967 Arab League Summit in Khartoum?

Q3. Explain the strategic significance of the captured territories for Israel's military security.

Q4. How did the Israeli policy of building Jewish settlements in the occupied territories impact the local Arab population?

Q5. Why did the Popular Front for the Liberation of Palestine (PFLP) hijack commercial airliners to Dawson's Field in 1970?

Q6. Why did King Hussein of Jordan view the PLO as a threat to his sovereignty by 1970?

Q7. What was the outcome of the 'Black September' civil war in Jordan in 1970?

Q8. Describe the events and consequences of the 1972 Munich Olympic Games terrorist attack.

Q9. Write a narrative account analysing the key developments in the Palestinian issue in the years 1970–72. (8 marks)

Pair & Share Activity

Prompt: Why did the spectacular Israeli victory in 1967 actually make a long-term peace agreement more difficult?

Your Notes:

GCSE Exam Practice

GCSE Exam Practice

Explain one consequence of the Six Day War (1967). (4 marks)

Exam Practice

1. Explain one consequence of the 1967 Six Day War. (4 marks)

2. Explain the importance of the occupied territories for Israelis and Palestinians after 1967. (8 marks)

6. Explain one consequence of the expulsion of the PLO from Jordan in 1970. (4 marks)

7. Explain one consequence of the PFLP airplane hijacks of 1970. (4 marks)

3. Explain the importance of Israel's consolidation of control of the occupied territories for relations between Israel and the Palestinians in the years 1967–73. (8 marks)

4. Explain the importance of the occupied territories for relations between Israel and the Arab world after the Six Day War, 1967. (8 marks)

5. Explain the importance of the use of Terrorism by Palestinians in the 1970's for the Palestinian issue. (8 marks)

8. Explain the importance of the expulsion of the PLO from Jordan, 1970, for PLO activities in Lebanon. (8 marks)

General Notes

[illegible]

- ☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

L3: KT2.3: Israel and Egypt, 1967–1973

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Analyze Egyptian relations with Israel, the USA, the USSR and other Arab states.
- ☐ Understand Israel's consolidation of control of the occupied territories.
- ☐ Describe the key events of the Yom Kippur War (1973) and its aftermath.

Determined to avenge the humiliation of 1967 and regain the Sinai Peninsula, Egypt's Anwar Sadat launched a surprise attack on Israel during Yom Kippur, the holiest day in the Jewish calendar. The initial Arab success shattered Israel's feeling of invincibility and forced them back to the negotiating table.

Did you know?

- Yom Kippur: October 6, 1973, when Egyptian and Syrian forces launched their coordinated surprise attack.
- The Bar Lev Line: The supposedly impenetrable Israeli sand defenses along the Suez Canal, which Egypt breached in hours using water cannons.
- Oil Embargo: Arab oil-producing states stopped selling oil to countries supporting Israel, causing a global economic crisis.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

1. What major United Nations Security Council Resolution was passed on 22 November 1967 to establish the guiding principles of a 'land for peace' formula?

2. Name the radical, Marxist-leaning Palestinian group founded by George Habash that pioneered international aviation terrorism in the early 1970s.

3. Explain how a translation discrepancy in the wording of UN Resolution 242 created a loophole that hindered its implementation.

4. What Arabic term refers to the Arab League Summit of August 1967, and what were the famous declarations issued there?

5. What was the immediate result of the Dawson's Field hijackings of September 1970 for the PLO's position in Jordan?

6. To which country did the PLO relocate its central headquarters after its expulsion from Jordan in 1970–71?

7. Describe the events of the Munich Olympics of September 1972 and state how Israel's Prime Minister Golda Meir responded.

8. How did Israel's capture of the Golan Heights, the West Bank, the Gaza Strip, and the Sinai Peninsula in 1967 initially improve its military security?

9. Why did the PLO reject UN Resolution 242?

10. Write an analytical sentence linking the outcome of the Six Day War to the rise of international Palestinian terrorism.

Vocabulary Check

*Write a clear definition and a historically accurate sentence for the term: **War of Attrition***

Q1. How did Israel respond to Nasser's artillery bombardments during the War of Attrition, and what was Nasser's reaction?

Q2. Why did Anwar Sadat believe he desperately needed to secure the return of the Sinai Peninsula?

Q3. What was the 'Peace for Sinai' offer proposed by Anwar Sadat, and why did Golda Meir reject it?

Q4. Why did Sadat expel 15,000 Soviet advisers from Egypt in July 1972, and what was the US reaction?

Q5. What was the Bar Lev Line, and what was its purpose?

Q6. How did the Egyptian army successfully breach the Bar Lev Line at the start of the Yom Kippur War?

Q7. Describe the superpower proxy conflict that emerged during the Yom Kippur War.

Q8. How did the Arab members of OPEC attempt to force the United States to restrain Israel?

Q9. Write a narrative account analysing the key developments of the Yom Kippur War (1973) and its aftermath. (8 marks)

Pair & Share Activity

Prompt: How did the Yom Kippur War change the psychological balance of power between Israel and the Arab states?

Your Notes:

1. Explain the importance of superpower (USA/USSR) involvement in the conflict in the Middle East 1967-73. (8 marks)

2. Write a narrative account analysing the key events of Egypt's relationship with Israel 1968-73. (8 marks)

3. Explain one consequence of the ongoing dispute over the Suez Canal 1967-73. (4 marks)

6. Explain one consequence of the 1973 Yom Kippur War. (4 marks)

4. Write a narrative account analysing relations between Egypt and other states in the years 1967-73. (8 marks)

5. Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the 1973 Yom Kippur War. (8 marks)

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